

Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1

Strong performance in a folding convertible

₹1,01,189



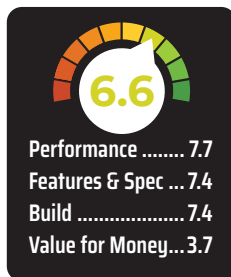
As a journalist, my day is full of multitasking.

One moment, I am juggling several Google Chrome tabs, and the next, I am hurriedly doodling something before I forget it. Add meetings, interviews, and impromptu calls to the mix, and you have a schedule that's nothing short of chaotic. In such a world, finding a machine that can keep up isn't easy, as it needs to be ultra-portable, powerful, and versatile. And when I received the Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 laptop, I decided to try it out as my daily driver, a decision that has worked wonders.

Housed in a sleek 14-inch frame, the Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 immediately strikes you with its premium look. At a glance, you might even mistake it for a MacBook. Priced around Rs 1 lakh, this laptop is clearly aimed at professionals seeking a reliable, all-round companion that adapts to their dynamic work style. But does it deliver as expected? Let's dive in and find out.

DESIGN AND KEYBOARD

As mentioned already, Dell has kept



things minimal, compact, and practical when it comes to the design. The laptop comes in a sleek and ultra-portable form factor. It has 12.36 inches of width, 0.65-inch height and 8.9 inch depth. It weighs 1.6 kg and can be easily carried around in a single hand.

The unit I received is a gorgeous dark blue colour, and it looks very similar to that of a M3 MacBook Air Midnight colourway. During my usage, I noticed some smudges developing on the chassis, but those can be easily wiped away. The chassis has a metallic look which enhances its overall appeal. However, the build is plastic.

The highlight is the 360-degree hinge that instantly transforms the laptop into a tablet. And thanks to its compact form factor, you can easily use the laptop as a tablet with one hand without having to worry about it falling out of your hands. With that being said, the hinge appears to be fragile, as when I opened the laptop for the first time, I had to put a bit of extra force to lift the lid. Also, when you press on the lid, you will notice a minor flex.

On the right, there is a USB Type A port along with a headphone jack. On the left, there are two Type C ports (one for charging) and an HDMI port. With only one extra Type-C port available besides the charging slot, I had to rely on a hub to connect my wireless keyboard and mouse. It's not a deal-breaker, but for those who aren't keen on investing in a separate hub, the limited port options might feel a bit restrictive.

Then there is a compact keyboard and a decent-sized trackpad with a smooth texture. It does its job well, most of the time. It did struggle a bit to register button presses and multifinger gestures at times

Coming to the keyboard, the laptop has evenly spread out keys that are super satisfying to type on. The keyboard is backlit and lets you work uninterrupted even in the dark. There is also a dedicated Copilot key that brings Microsoft's AI assistant to life instantly. Combined with the function keys are several shortcut keys to control volume, brightness, external displays and so on. The power button is located on the top right of the screen, right next to the delete button. This proved a bit of a challenge for me, as I at times mistakenly pressed the power button while pressing the delete button. Again, not a dealbreaker, but a minor inconvenience that eventually went away as I got used to the keyboard.

DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

Coming to the display, it is sharp, and super immersive thanks to the slim bezels. However, during our testing via Calman, we noticed slight issues with colour accuracy. Now this won't be much noticeable if you are just casually watching content on the device. However, it might matter to artists who want 100 percent colour accuracy.

Speaking in technical terms, the display is a 14-inch WVA (Wide Viewing Angle) screen with 60 Hz refresh rate and 300 nits brightness. The display also sports 2K resolution which makes it just right for binge-watching.